

GENUINE

1. Passage anchor

> “You don't need to sound perfect; you need to sound **genuine**.”

Passage meaning

genuine = sincere, natural, and honestly reflecting what you really think or feel

真誠的；真心的；不做作的

Here, Mrs. Chan is telling the speaker that effective communication does not require flawless English. It is more important to sound **authentic and sincere**.

Practice

1. Her answer sounded **genuine**, not rehearsed.

她的回答聽起來很**真誠**，不像背好的。

2. People usually respond well when you speak in a **genuine** way.

當你以**真誠自然的方式**說話時，人們通常會有較好的反應。

Core meanings of GENUINE

2. genuine — sincere and honest in feelings or behavior

= truly felt, meant, or expressed; not fake or pretended

真誠的；真心的；由衷的

This is the passage sense and one of the most important everyday meanings.

Examples

1. She showed **genuine concern** for the students.

她對學生表現出**真誠的關心**。

2. He gave me a **genuine apology**.

他向我作出了**真心的道歉**。

Common collocations:

* genuine concern

* genuine interest

* genuine sympathy

- * genuine enthusiasm
- * genuine affection
- * genuine apology

3. genuine — natural and not artificial in manner

= behaving in a way that feels real rather than forced, calculated, or performative

****自然真實的；不做作的****

Examples

1. Her smile was warm and ****genuine****.
她的笑容溫暖而****真誠自然****。

2. He comes across as very ****genuine****.
他給人的感覺非常****真實、不做作****。

This sense is especially common when describing:

- * personality
- * speech
- * emotion
- * social interaction

4. a genuine person

= a person who is sincere, honest, and not pretending to be something they are not

****真誠的人；待人真實的人****

Examples

1. She is one of the most ****genuine people**** I know.
她是我認識的人當中最****真誠****的之一。

2. He seems like a ****genuine person****.
他看起來是個****真實誠懇的人****。

This usually evaluates character, not factual authenticity of identity.

Real vs fake

5. genuine — real, not fake or imitation

= actually what it claims to be

****真的；真正的；非仿冒的****

Examples

1. Is this a ****genuine**** leather bag?

這是真正的****皮革包****嗎？

2. The painting was confirmed to be ****genuine****.

這幅畫被證實是****真品****。

This is a major distinct branch from emotional sincerity.

6. genuine product / article / item

= authentic rather than counterfeit or imitation

****真品；正品；非仿冒品的****

Examples

1. Make sure you are buying a ****genuine product****.

請確認你買的是****正品****。

2. Experts examined the watch to determine whether it was ****genuine****.

專家檢查那只手錶，以確定它是否為****真品****。

Common in:

* luxury goods

* collectibles

* art

* branded products

* documents

7. genuine leather / gold / material

= truly made of the stated material rather than imitation material

****真正的……；純正的……****

Examples

1. The jacket is made from **genuine leather**.
這件外套是用**真皮**製成的。

2. The necklace contains **genuine gold**.
這條項鍊含有**真金**。

Important nuance

genuine leather means real animal leather rather than synthetic imitation. It does not necessarily mean the highest grade of leather.

Authenticity and identity

8. genuine — authentic; truly belonging to a claimed origin, type, or period

= actually originating from the source, period, or category claimed

真實的；貨真價實的；真正屬於.....的

Examples

1. The museum owns several **genuine Roman coins**.
博物館收藏了數枚**真正的古羅馬硬幣**。

2. Experts believe the document is **genuine**.
專家認為這份文件是**真的**。

This is common in:

- * art
- * antiques
- * historical objects
- * documents
- * signatures

9. genuine signature / document / evidence

= authentic rather than forged or fabricated

真實的；非偽造的

Examples

1. The police confirmed that the signature was **genuine**.

警方確認那個簽名是**真實的**。

2. Investigators questioned whether the document was **genuine**.

調查人員質疑那份文件是否**真實可信**。

True nature or category

10. genuine — truly belonging to a category

= possessing the essential qualities of the thing described

真正的；名副其實的

Examples

1. This is a **genuine emergency**.

這是一次**真正的緊急情況**。

2. The discovery represents a **genuine breakthrough**.

這項發現代表一次**真正的突破**。

Here, **genuine** means the label is fully justified.

11. genuine need / problem / concern

= real and substantial rather than imagined, exaggerated, or invented

真正存在的；實際的

Examples

1. There is a **genuine need** for more affordable housing.

對更多可負擔住房確實存在**真正的需求**。

2. Her concerns were **genuine**.

她的擔憂是**真實存在的**。

This often contrasts with:

* artificial

* exaggerated

* imaginary

* manufactured

12. genuine reason / excuse

= a real and honest reason rather than a fabricated one

****真實的理由；並非捏造的理由****

Examples

1. He had a ****genuine reason**** for being late.

他遲到有一個****真正的理由****。

2. If you have a ****genuine excuse****, explain it clearly.

如果你確實有****真實合理的理由****，就清楚說明。

Degree and emphasis

13. genuine surprise / shock / pleasure

= emotion that is truly felt

****真正的驚訝 / 震驚 / 喜悅****

Examples

1. Her face showed ****genuine surprise****.

她臉上露出****真實的驚訝****。

2. He seemed ****genuinely pleased**** to see us.

他見到我們似乎真的****由衷高興****。

The important contrast is between:

* real emotion

* acted or polite emotion

14. genuine passion / enthusiasm

= sincere and deeply felt interest or excitement

****真正的熱情；由衷的熱忱****

Examples

1. She has a ****genuine passion for teaching****.
她對教學有****真心的熱情****。
2. His ****genuine enthusiasm**** made the presentation engaging.
他****由衷的熱忱****讓簡報更吸引人。

GENUINE in judgments and claims

15. genuine attempt / effort

= a sincere, serious attempt rather than a token or insincere one
****真心的嘗試；認真的努力****

Examples

1. He made a ****genuine effort**** to improve.
他確實****認真努力****想要進步。
2. This was a ****genuine attempt**** to solve the problem.
這是一次****真正認真的嘗試****，目的是解決問題。

This often implies good faith.

16. genuine commitment

= sincere and real willingness to support or continue something
****真正的承諾；真誠的投入****

Examples

1. The project requires ****genuine commitment**** from everyone.
這個專案需要每個人都****真正投入****。
2. She showed ****genuine commitment**** to the team.
她展現了對團隊的****真誠投入****。

17. genuine desire

= a sincerely felt wish

****真心的願望；真正的意願****

Examples

1. He showed a ****genuine desire to learn****.

他展現出****真心想學習的意願****。

2. Her decision came from a ****genuine desire to help****.

她的決定源自****真心想幫助別人的願望****。

Related forms

18. genuinely

= sincerely; really; authentically

****真誠地；真正地；確實地****

Examples

1. I was ****genuinely surprised**** by the result.

我對結果感到****真的很驚訝****。

2. She ****genuinely cares**** about her students.

她****真心關心****自己的學生。

Depending on context, it can mean:

* sincerely

* truly

* really

19. genuineness

= the quality of being sincere, real, or authentic

****真誠；真實性；真偽程度****

Examples

1. People responded to the ****genuineness**** of her message.

人們對她訊息中的****真誠****產生了共鳴。

2. Experts questioned the ****genuineness**** of the painting.

專家質疑這幅畫的****真實性 / 是否為真品****。

The Chinese depends on which ****genuine**** meaning is active.

High-value patterns

20. sound genuine

= sound sincere and natural rather than artificial or rehearsed

****聽起來真誠；聽起來自然不做作****

This is the exact passage construction.

Examples

1. Try to ****sound genuine**** rather than perfect.

與其追求完美，不如讓自己****聽起來真誠自然****。

2. His apology did not ****sound genuine****.

他的道歉聽起來****不太真誠****。

21. seem / appear genuine

= appear sincere or authentic

****看起來真誠 / 真實****

Examples

1. Her concern seemed ****genuine****.

她的關心看起來是****真心的****。

2. The signature appears ****genuine****.

那個簽名看起來是****真的****。

Notice that the Chinese translation changes according to context:

* person/emotion → 真誠

* object/document → 真實 / 真品

22. be genuinely interested

= truly have interest rather than pretending to

****真的感興趣；出自真心地感興趣****

Examples

1. She was ****genuinely interested**** in what I had to say.

她對我要說的話是****真的感興趣****。

2. Good interviewers are ****genuinely interested**** in people.

優秀的訪談者會****真心對人感興趣****。

Important semantic distinction

23. sincere-person branch

****genuine**** can describe someone's:

- * feelings
- * personality
- * intentions
- * reactions
- * communication

Meaning:

****sincere / heartfelt / natural****

****真誠的；真心的；不做作的****

Examples:

- * genuine smile
- * genuine concern
- * genuine apology
- * genuine person

24. authentic-object branch

****genuine**** can describe:

- * products

- * documents
- * artwork
- * materials
- * signatures
- * antiques

Meaning:

****real / authentic / not fake****
****真的；真品的；非偽造的****

Examples:

- * genuine leather
- * genuine painting
- * genuine signature
- * genuine Rolex

These two branches are related through the central concept ****“not fake”****, but learners should distinguish them clearly.

Key contrasts

25. genuine vs sincere

Both can mean ****真誠的****, but they are not completely identical.

sincere

focuses strongly on honesty of feeling or intention

****誠懇的；真心的****

genuine

can mean either:

- * sincere and natural
- * authentic and not fake

Compare:

- > a ****sincere apology****
- > 一個真誠的道歉

> a ****genuine apology**** ✓
> 一個真正出自真心的道歉

Both are natural.

But:

> a ****genuine diamond**** ✓
> 一顆真鑽石

> a ****sincere diamond**** ✗

So ****genuine**** has a much broader authenticity sense.

26. genuine vs authentic

They overlap strongly in the “real, not fake” sense.

genuine

= actually what it claims to be

****真的；真品的****

authentic

= genuine in origin or faithful to an original tradition/style

****真實的；正宗的；原汁原味的****

Compare:

* a ****genuine signature**** = 真實簽名

* an ****authentic Italian recipe**** = 正宗義大利食譜

For people and emotions:

* genuine concern ✓ very natural

* authentic concern is possible, but less ordinary

27. genuine vs real

****real**** is broader and more everyday.

****genuine**** often stresses contrast with:

- * fake
- * imitation
- * artificial
- * insincere

Compare:

> Is that ****real gold****?

> 那是真金嗎？

> Is that ****genuine gold****?

> 那真的是金子嗎？

Both work, but ****genuine**** more explicitly emphasizes authenticity.

28. genuine vs honest

****honest****

= truthful; not lying or cheating

****誠實的****

****genuine****

= sincere, real, or authentic

****真誠的；真實的****

A person can be:

* ****honest**** about facts

* ****genuine**** in personality or emotion

They overlap but are not synonyms in every context.

29. genuine vs natural

In communication:

****natural****

= relaxed, ordinary, not forced

****自然的****

****genuine****

= sincere and truly reflecting your feelings/personality

****真誠的；真實的****

A speaker can sound natural without necessarily sounding genuine, and genuine without being perfectly polished.

This distinction matters in the passage.

30. genuine vs original

****original****

can mean:

- * first
- * not copied
- * creative

****genuine****

means:

- * authentic
- * not fake

Compare:

- * the ****original painting**** = 原畫 / 最初的畫作
- * a ****genuine painting by Picasso**** = 真正的畢卡索畫作

An object can be an original design but still be a reproduction in another sense, so the words should not be treated as identical.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****genuine**** is:

****not false, fake, artificial, or pretended****

From this core idea develop two major branches:

Human/emotional authenticity

not pretending
→ genuine smile
→ genuine concern
→ genuine apology
→ genuine person
→ ****真誠的；真心的；不做作的****

Object/factual authenticity

not counterfeit or fabricated
→ genuine leather
→ genuine signature
→ genuine artwork
→ ****真的；真品的；非偽造的****

A third closely related branch is:

Real significance/existence

not imaginary, trivial, or merely apparent
→ genuine need
→ genuine problem
→ genuine breakthrough
→ ****真正的；確實存在的****

Passage recap

> “You don't need to sound perfect; you need to sound ****genuine****.”

Here, ****genuine**** means:

****sincere, natural, and honestly expressing yourself****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* ****真誠的****

* ****真實自然的****

* ****不做作的****

* contextually: ****你不需要聽起來完美，只需要聽起來真誠自然****

MCQ-ready meaning

****genuine**** in the passage

= ****sincere and real rather than artificial or pretended****

****真誠的；真心的；不做作的****

It does not mean “genuine product / 真品” here, although both senses share the same deeper concept:

****not fake****.